A Comparison of Passive, Assertive and Aggressive Behaviors:

Passive	Assertive	Aggressive
Verbal Behaviors		
You avoid saying what you want, think or feel. If you do, you say them in such a way that you put yourself down. Apologetic words with hidden meanings are frequent. A smoke screen of vague words or silence. “Know” “Well…”, “I mean…”, “I guess”, and “I’m sorry”. You allow others to choose for you.	You say what you honestly want, think and feel in direct and helpful ways. You make your own choices. You communicate with tact and humor. You use “I” statements. Your words are clear and well chosen.	You say what you want, think and feel, but at the expense of others. You use “loaded words” and “you” statements that label and blame. You are full of threats or accusations and apply one-upmanship.
Non-Verbal Behaviors		
You use actions instead of words. You hope someone will guess what you want. You took as if you don’t mean what you say. Your voice is weak, hesitant and soft. You whisper in a monotone. Your eyes are to the side or downcast. You nod your head to almost anything anyone says. You sit or stand as far away as you can from the other person. You don’t know what to do with your hands and they are trembling or clammy. You look uncomfortable, shuffle and are tense or inhibited.	You listen closely. Your manner is calm and assured. You communicate caring and strength. Your voice is firm, warm and expressive. You look directly at the other person, but you don’t stare. You face the person. Your hands are relaxed. You hold your head erect and you lean toward the other person. You have a relaxed expression.	Your present yourself as very determined. Your voice is loud and challenging. You look around with a cool, fixed look. You fix your opponent with your eyes. You threaten the other person. Your hands are rolled into fists or you are making threatening gestures with them.

Source: The Stress Reduction and Relaxation Program Workbook Center for Mindfulness in Medicine, Health Care and Society, University of Massachusetts Medical School Worcester, USA - Gözde Tutanç **©All rights reserved.**

Your Apparent Goals And Feelings

Goals		
To please to be liked.	To communicate, to be respected	To dominate or humiliate.
Feelings		
Passive	**Assertive**	**Aggressive**
You feel anxious, ignored, hurt manipulated and disappointed with yourself. You are often angry and resentful later.	You feel confident and successful. You feel good about yourself at that time and later. You feel in control, you have self-respect and you are goal oriented.	You feel self righteous, controlling and superior. Sometimes you feel embarrassed or selfish later.

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Your Apparent Payoffs

Passive	Assertive	Aggressive
You avoid unpleasant situations, conflicts, short-term tensions and confrontations. You don't have to take responsibility for your choices.	You feel good. You feel respected by others. Your self-confidence improves. You make your own choices. Your relationships with others are improved. You have very little physical distress now or later. You are in touch with your feelings.	You get some anger off your chest. You get a feeling of control. You feel superior.

The Effects on Others

Their Feelings

They feel guilty, superior, frustrated or even anger.	They feel respected or valued. They feel free to express themselves.	They feel humiliated, depreciated or hurt...

Their feeling towards you

They feel irritated. They pity and depreciate you. They feel frustrated and disgusted with you. The lose respect for you because you are pushover and someone who does no know where he stands	They usually respect, trust and value you. They know where you stand.	They feel hurt, defensive, humiliated or angry. They resent, distrust and fear you. They may want revenge

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Probable Outcomes Of Each Type Of Behavior

Passive	Assertive	Aggressive
You don't get what you want. If you do get your own way, it is indirect. You feel emotionally dishonest. Others achieve their goals at your expense. Your rights are violated. Your anger builds up and you either push it down or redirect it toward other people who are less powerful. You may find yourself procrastinating, suffering in silence, dong things half-heartedly, being sloppy, or becoming forgetful. You get maneuvered. Loneliness and isolation may become part of your life.	You often get what you want if it is reasonable. You often achieve your goals. You gain self-respect. You feel good. You convert win-lose to win-win. The outcome is determined by above-board negotiations. Your rights and other's rights are respected-	You often get what you want, but a t the expense of others. You hurt others by making choices for them and infantizing them. Others feel a right to "get even". You may have increasing difficulty with relaxing and "unwinding" later.

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